JACOB HANWOOL CHOI

Nursing · Patient Communication · Health Access

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Nobody in his family had navigated an American hospital before he translated for them. Jacob now helps make the tools, and tell the stories, that help other families reach care that is already there.

EDUCATION

Palisades Park Jr./Sr. High School, Palisades Park, New Jersey *Class of 2027*
Engineering Academy. Coursework: AP Calculus, AP Physics, US History 2. SAT 1360 (December 2025): 740 Math, 620 Reading and Writing.
College Board National Recognition Program, First-Generation and School Recognition Awards (2026); Scholastic Art and Writing Awards, Honorable Mention (2026); Korean Honor Society; Principal's List; Honor Roll.
Intended study: nursing, with an interest in orthopedic and rehabilitative care.

FILM& RESEARCH

The Wait *YGLE documentary, bilingual patient card, and resource flyers, 2026 to present*
Production and Filming Lead

- Handle filming, camera work, and editing for a student documentary about Korean immigrants who put off medical and dental care until an illness grows worse, often because of the language barrier; released on YouTube in October 2026 (*THE WAIT: A Student Documentary by YGLE*).
- With the senior leadership team, reviewed the design of a six-panel Korean and English hospital card (interpreter request, symptoms, pain scale, dental visit); medical content reviewed by a registered nurse, dental content by a dentist; 300 printed and donated in New Jersey and New York.
- Ran the team's booth at the Korean Community Center in Tenafly on October 17, 2026: handed cards to Korean seniors, spoke with Tenafly's mayor, and took card requests from translation and elder support organizations.
- Team also produced two bilingual flyers on free and low-cost health screening and dental services in Bergen County.

Independent Medical Research *mentored by a Johns Hopkins biostatistician, 2025 to present*

- Literature review comparing treatments for fungal and bacterial otitis externa across published studies; paper in progress.

HOSPITAL EXPERIENCE

Intern, Patient and Visitor Guide *Englewood Hospital (Englewood Health), April 2026 to present*

- Guide patients and visitors to the right department at a six-time Magnet hospital; learn what each unit does and observe nursing teams at work.

LEADERSHIP

Donation Coordinator *CDHW, Clothing Donations to Help Kids in the World, 2025 to present*

- Handle intake, sorting, and delivery visits for new clothing to pediatric patients at New Jersey hospitals, including Hackensack University Medical Center; the program gave more than $15,000 in new clothing in 2025.

Wellness Resources Lead *VOY, Voices of the Young, 2025 to present*

- Keep the mental health resources and crisis contacts in VOY's Mo Soop peer support app and Mo Ri ADHD app up to date, with review by a licensed professional.

Director of Communications *YGLE, Young Global Leaders of the East, 2025 to present*

- Handle outreach and messaging for a youth leadership organization and recruit participants for its annual Global Leadership Forum.

Leading Mentor and Tutor *Walk Alongside, 2025 to present*

- Coordinate the tutor schedule for a free tutoring, mentoring, and SAT prep program; tutor and mentor students who cannot afford private academic help.

SERVICE

Volunteer, Saturday Meal Service *Neighbor Plus, 2023 to present*

- Serve Saturday meals to neighbors in need every week since ninth grade; several hundred documented hours. President's Volunteer Service Award, Gold (2024); Neighbor Plus Volunteer Service Award, Silver (2025).

Student Volunteer *LiNK North Jersey Rescue Team, 2024 to present*

- Help at awareness events and fundraisers organized with national LiNK for North Korean refugees.

ATHLETICS

Varsity Swimming, 2023 to present: All-Conference, two seasons; Second Team All-League (2025); state championship competitor. **Club Swimming**, Rebels Aquatic Club, year-round; two hours of training each summer morning. Junior Varsity Tennis.

WORK

Lifeguard, Palisades Park Swim Club, paid summer position, 2023 to present: supervises open swim and enforces water safety. **Swim Instructor and Private Coach**, Palisades Park Swim Club, paid, 2025 to present: teaches beginning and competitive swimmers.

LANGUAGES &CERT.

Korean and English; interpreter for his parents at medical appointments since childhood.
American Red Cross Lifeguarding (Including Deep Water) with CPR/AED for Professional Rescuers and First Aid, valid through May 2028.